PARETO TALENT · FREE FOUNDER AUDIT · UNDER 10 MINUTES

The Founder's Bottleneck Audit

Find the 10 Hours a Week You Should Never Touch Again

The average founder runs about 14 systems from memory. This audit zooms in on the 8 where the hours hide, shows you which ones still run through you, and tells you exactly what to hand off first.

10+

hours a week most founders find

1 — 1 min

Warm up

Tick the signals that are true for you this month.

2 — 6 min

Score 8 systems

Two numbers each: who runs it, and how many hours it takes you.

3 — 3 min

Get your plan

Your score, your Hand-off Hours, the cost and what to hand off first.

“I'm the bottleneck in my own company.”

That's the sentence we hear most from founders. Not because they're bad at delegating, but because nobody ever showed them **what to delegate first**. So they delegate nothing, and every decision, reply and follow-up waits for them. In 10 minutes you'll turn “I'm drowning” into a ranked list with hours on it.

Warm-up: which of these are true this month?

Pareto analysed 1,500+ calls with founders. These six signals came up again and again. Tick every one that's true for you.

	SHARE OF FOUNDERS WHO SAID IT
☐ I'm drowning in admin: inbox, scheduling, invoices, follow-ups.	80%
☐ I have no time left for strategy, family or my own health.	70%
☐ I've been burned by a VA or assistant before.	60%
☐ Most of the business runs from my memory, not from a system.	50%
☐ Things fall through the cracks every week.	40%
☐ I wear too many hats to do any of them well.	30%

Signals ticked: _____ / 6 Ticked 3 or more? Keep going: the next page shows where the hours hide.

How to score read once, takes 20 seconds

Every system on the next page is work a trained, trusted person can own. For each one, write two numbers:

A Who runs it?

0 someone else owns it end to end
1 someone else does it, you check or approve
2 you do most of it, with a little help
3 only you. If you stop, it stops.

B Hours a week

Your honest best guess of the hours **you personally** spend on it each week. Round to the nearest hour. A guess is fine: precision doesn't change the answer.

Tip: if you're torn between two scores, pick the higher one. Founders almost always underestimate this.

Where do your hours go?

If the “still yours if” line describes you, column A is probably 2 or 3.

#	SYSTEM · STILL YOURS IF…	A. WHO RUNS IT (0 to 3)	B. HOURS (per week)
01	**Inbox and messages** Email, Slack and WhatsApp all route through you, and nothing gets answered unless you answer it.		
02	**Calendar, meetings and follow-up** You schedule your own meetings, walk in cold and write your own recaps, if at all.		
03	**Travel and personal admin** You book your own flights, renew your own subscriptions and chase your own appointments.		
04	**Sales follow-ups, proposals and CRM** Leads go quiet because you didn't follow up, and you write proposals at night.		
05	**Client onboarding and updates** New clients wait on you for kickoff, and existing ones email you for status.		
06	**Invoicing, bills and expenses** You send invoices, chase late payments and file receipts yourself.		
07	**Team, hiring and project follow-through** You assign the work, chase deadlines and schedule every interview. The real project list lives in your head.		
08	**SOPs, tools and content** Nobody else knows how things are done, new tools get set up by you, and posts go out only when you find time.		

YOUR TOTALS

Bottleneck Score

Add up column A for all 8 systems. _____ / 24

Hand-off Hours

Add up column B, only where A is 2 or 3. _____ hrs/wk

What your Bottleneck Score means

0–6

The Delegator

Most systems already run without you. Hand off the one or two still leaking hours.

7–12

Stretched

The obvious work is gone, but you're still the glue: follow-ups, coordination, admin.

13–18

The Bottleneck

Work waits for you every day. You built a company, and now you're working in it as a job.

19–24

The Business Is You

Two weeks off and most of the company stops. Most urgent, and most fixable.

What your Hand-off Hours mean

0–4	You're close. Tighten one or two systems and you're done.
5–9	A real day a week of work someone else should own. Worth handing off this quarter.
10–19	**You found the 10 hours.** That's 40+ hours a month, the number Pareto's Freedom 40 Guarantee gives back to founders in their first 30 days.
20+	Half a work week, every week, on work that doesn't need you. A full-time Right Hand pays for itself in month one.

WHAT THOSE HOURS COST YOU

Rule of thumb: your time is worth at least your annual revenue divided by 2,000 working hours.

1. **Your hourly value** — annual revenue $ _____ ÷ 2,000 = $ _____ an hour
2. **Weekly cost** — Hand-off Hours _____ × hourly value = $ _____ a week
3. **Yearly cost** — weekly cost × 50 weeks = $ _____ a year

Example: a founder doing $1M a year is worth about $500 an hour. With 12 Hand-off Hours that's $6,000 a week, or **$300,000 a year** of founder time spent on work someone else should own. A full-time Right Hand from Pareto costs $3,600 a month ($43,200 a year), plus a one-time $3,000 placement fee.

Hand off first

Write down your 3 systems with the most hours where A is 2 or 3. Start with the biggest. **For most founders, #1 is the inbox.**

RANK	SYSTEM	HRS/WK	WHAT "DONE" LOOKS LIKE, IN ONE SENTENCE
1			
2			
3			

Your first 30 days

WEEK 1

Give access, record once

Share inbox and calendar with clear rules. Record a 5-minute video of you doing system #1.

WEEK 2

They do, you review

Daily end-of-day report: Done, In progress, Blockers. Correct once, then let go.

WEEK 3

They own it

You only see what needs your judgment. Record system #2.

WEEK 4

Hand off #2 and #3

Re-score this audit. The drop in Hand-off Hours is your reclaimed time.

RATHER NOT DO IT ALONE?

A Right Hand from Pareto takes this list off your plate.

A full-time, AI-trained operator from Latin America, fluent in English, matched to you in 24 hours (1 in 1,000 applicants accepted; 93% of placements still together at 12 months). Backed by three guarantees: **Freedom 40** (40+ hours back in 30 days or next month free), **Matching** (no payment until you're excited about your match) and **Lifetime Replacement**.

Doing **$500K a year or more** and scored **13+** (or found **10+ Hand-off Hours**)? Book a free 30-minute Right Hand Fit Call. Bring this audit, and leave with your first 30 days of delegation mapped, whether or not you hire.

Book your Right Hand Fit Call →

fp-martin-gorosito.vibepreview.app/book

Numbers from paretotalent.com, checked October 2026.